

Matthew Beardwell

Watford, Hertfordshire · contact@mbeardwell.com · mbeardwell.com

[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · [TryHackMe](#)

Professional Summary

Security Analyst with strengths in digital forensics and OSINT. Experience includes ARM instruction patching and binary analysis. Recovered deleted data and artefacts in both lab-based and real-world contexts. Completed 116 hands-on labs (~100 hrs, Top 2% TryHackMe) and earned a First-Class BSc in Computer Science from King's College London. Currently preparing for CompTIA Security+.

Technical Skills

- **Scripting and Programming:** Python, Bash, PowerShell, C, ARM Assembly
- **Networking:** Wireshark, TCP/IP analysis, PCAP inspection
- **Forensics:** Autopsy, dd, foremost, photorec, scalpel; disk image recovery and file carving
- **OSINT:** Identity/location tracing, metadata correlation, client investigations, toolkit authoring
- **Reverse Engineering:** GDB, IDA Free, Ghidra, radare2, ARM runtime patching

Cybersecurity Projects

ActiveReconLite · Python Port Scanner

FEB 2025 – MAR 2025

Built a Python-based TCP connect port scanner using multiprocessing. Outperforms Nmap in some cases by 60x; scanned 65k ports in 5s (vs Nmap's 5m). It validates user input, grabs banners, and writes results to a file. Demonstrates automation, socket programming, and parallel scanning. github.com/mbeardwell/active-recon-lite

Location and Identity Resolution from Minimal Public Signals · OSINT Case Study

APR 2025

Tracked real-world identity from anonymised YouTube uploads using public data. Shows attacker thinking, threat profiling, and privacy risk awareness. Demonstrates threat intelligence process fundamentals: collection, enrichment, analysis, and attribution based on minimal public indicators. github.com/mbeardwell/osint-i3-case-study

UK Person-centric OSINT Toolkit

JUN 2025

Curation of UK-only, legal person-focused OSINT resources for investigative use. Supports human profiling, exposure tracking, and background validation tasks. Featured on OSINTTech (Substack); 100+ LinkedIn/Substack views in 1 week. github.com/mbeardwell/uk-personal-osint-toolkit

Faster Dynamically Instrumented Programs · Bachelor's Thesis

OCT 2022 – MAY 2023

Built a runtime patching tool on ARM Linux to redirect processor instructions in memory. Mirrors techniques used in evasive malware. github.com/mbeardwell/arm-fp-emu

Professional Experience

Building expertise during ongoing health recovery. Not currently available for roles. Open to future opportunities.

Security Training and Labs · TryHackMe (Self-Led Learning)

FEB 2022 – PRESENT

Completed 116 hands-on labs (~100 hrs) that included digital forensics, OSINT, and reverse engineering. Ranked in the Top 2% globally.

Freelance OSINT Investigations · Freelance & Self-Led

2024 – 2025

Conducted multiple open-ended OSINT investigations, including one extensively documented client case and several self-led identity/location tracing projects.

Private Tutor · Freelance

SEP 2016 – NOV 2019

Supported children with pre-GCSE homework, primarily in maths; adapted explanations to varying ability levels in informal settings.

Research and Documentation Intern · Indo UK Institute of Health

JUN 2017 – AUG 2017

Conducted market research on employee benefits and strategic partnerships, providing executives with key insights. Edited and reformatted high-level strategic documents that shaped discussions on a billion-pound health-care initiative.

Education and Certifications

BSc (Hons) CS · King's College London

First-Class

SEP 2018 – JUL 2023

A-Levels · King's Maths School

A* A* A* A*

SEP 2016 – JUL 2018

Certifications

CompTIA	Security+	(IN PROGRESS)
TryHackMe	Intro to Cyber Security	FEB 2024
Security Blue Team	Intro to OSINT	JUN 2025
TryHackMe	Pre-Security	APR 2022
Prince's Trust	TEAM (12-week programme incl. First Aid)	JAN 2024 – APR 2024